

Tarjin Rahman, MLIS, MA, BSc (Hons)

Product Owner | Product Manager | UX, Research & Requirements | Analytics & Operational Systems

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Product owner, product manager, and research professional with 6+ years in formal Product Manager / Product Lead roles and more than two decades across software, UX, research, analytics, and regulated technology. Experienced translating operational workflows, stakeholder needs, data standards, relational schemas, and technical constraints into clear requirements, product priorities, validation criteria, and practical technology decisions. Led ACDSee Pro for Mac v1 from product definition through launch and a public beta of more than 10,000 users; led requirements analysis for a regulated electronic patient-care reporting system used in field operations; conducted usability research at Microsoft and global market research at Adobe; and spent eight years supporting strategic and operational decision-making with public-sector data, including large Oracle extracts, schema analysis, data cleaning, standardization, and validation. Current founder and product lead of Red5Sorcery, owning end-to-end product definition, workflow design, acceptance, QA evidence, and documentation for local-first browser software (Red5SorceryDataSculptor.com). Author of The Decision to Build, a work in progress detailing the product development practices and AI collaboration behind Red5Sorcery Data Sculptor.

CORE STRENGTHS

Product Ownership & Prioritization | Product Management | AI-Assisted Complex Software Development & Documentation (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini) | Business Analysis & Requirements | Operational Workflow Analysis | Process Improvement | User Experience & Usability | Acceptance Testing & Validation | Stakeholder Facilitation & Alignment | Cross-Functional Delivery | Roadmaps & Backlogs | Agile / Scrum | Data Quality & Analytics | Statistical Reporting & Publication | Executive Briefing & Data Visualization | Open Data Stewardship | Public Information & Data Requests | Cross-Unit Data Support | Data Cleaning, Standardization & Validation | Reference Data & Code Mapping | External Data Acquisition | Relational Data & Schema Analysis | SQL & PostgreSQL (working proficiency) | Documentation & Decision Traceability

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder & Product Lead

Feb 2025 - Present

Red5Sorcery Books & Media | Halifax, NS

- Founded Red5Sorcery Books & Media to publish technical books, source code, and software focused on privacy, data analysis, and practical technology, alongside separate games and entertainment projects.
- Lead product development end-to-end for Red5Sorcery software, from problem framing, workflow analysis, requirements, prioritization, and acceptance criteria through implementation decisions, QA evidence, documentation, release acceptance, and publication.
- Use AI extensively as part of a structured product-development workflow spanning requirements analysis, architecture support, implementation, adversarial QA, documentation, evaluation, and verification, while retaining final accountability for product decisions and acceptance.
- Conceived and shipped CloakYourSecrets.com, an offline browser privacy application built with Rust and WebAssembly, taking the product from concept through implementation, validation, release, documentation, and publication.
- Currently building Red5Sorcery Data Sculptor (Red5SorceryDataSculptor.com), a local-first browser application for private, explainable data analysis; define relational query behavior including joins, materialization, schema handling, and equivalent DS-STEPS / DS-SQL / DS-Pipe expressions.

Research & Statistics Officer

Jun 2018 - Oct 2026

Nova Scotia Government, Department of Justice | Halifax, NS

- Analyzed complex administrative and program data to support strategic and operational decisions; translated stakeholder questions, source limitations, and incomplete evidence into rigorous analyses, documented methods, and clear recommendations for decision-makers.
- Worked with large data extracts from the Justice Enterprise Information Network (JEIN) Oracle database, using its data schemas to interpret and validate operational justice data.
- Analyzed Oracle database schemas and data structures to determine how information could be reliably reported; identified structural and data-model limitations that constrained automation and translated findings into practical analysis approaches.
- Normalized inconsistent federal (primarily Criminal Code), provincial, and municipal offence descriptions and codes in data extracts for statistical analysis, researching governing statutes and offence/ticket codes to establish canonical wording and support accurate grouping and reporting.
- Served as Statistics Canada liaison for recurring annual dataset requests supporting the Nova Scotia Advisory Council on the Status of Women / Status of Women Office, and helped validate annual fact sheets for accuracy and consistency.
- Contributed statistical content to Status of Women fact sheets, including Domestic Violence in Nova Scotia, using JEIN and Statistics Canada source data and helping validate published figures, offence categories, rates, and year-over-year comparisons for accuracy and consistency.
- Produced much of the annual Corrections Key Indicators fact sheet/report, compiling, validating, analyzing, and presenting correctional statistics and multi-year trends in collaboration with colleagues under manager ownership.
- Contributed to validation and writing for an internal report on bail reform, reviewing report content and supporting clear, evidence-based analysis in collaboration with colleagues.
- Reviewed Justice-relevant Statistics Canada releases in The Daily and Juristat and led production of concise bullet-point briefings for the Senior Executive Team and accompanying infographics highlighting Nova Scotia statistics and trends, working with colleagues under manager ownership.
- Conducted work-in-progress reviews of Statistics Canada publications relevant to Nova Scotia, validating draft police-reported findings against JEIN data and independently reproducing results where possible using Nova Scotia UCR2 data; reconciled methodological differences and verified most draft claims for management review.
- Maintained more than 20 Department of Justice datasets on the Nova Scotia Open Data Portal, supporting recurring public-data updates with emphasis on data quality, validation, reproducibility, documentation, and clear interpretation; balanced scheduled releases, ad hoc requests, and competing stakeholder priorities.
- Handled a range of media FOIPOP data requests, working with JEIN extracts to retrieve, validate, shape, and summarize requested statistics and producing clear, presentation-ready tables for external consumption.
- Provided short-term data support to the Accessibility & Disabilities organization within Justice, reformatting public survey data from 2019-2024 for release on the Nova Scotia Open Data Portal.
- Served as a Department of Justice representative/member on the Joint Occupational Health and Safety Committee (JOHSC) from 2020.

Product Analyst

Nov 2013 - Jun 2017

Medusa Medical Technologies Inc. | Halifax, NS

- Led product and business requirements analysis for the Siren electronic patient-care reporting suite, translating operationally complex EMS field workflows and NEMSIS v3 standards into product specifications, data definitions, validation rules, and implementation decisions.

- Used Microsoft relational database tooling to inspect production data and existing table structures while analyzing requirements; worked with established schemas rather than administering or creating production tables.
- Worked across domain experts, customer and stakeholder needs, and engineering constraints to clarify ambiguous workflows, prioritize requirements, assess impacts, and support reliable delivery in a regulated healthcare environment.

Product Manager

Jan 2013 - May 2013

Radialpoint SafeCare Inc. | Montreal, QC

- Helped establish product-management practices, Agile roles, backlog planning, delivery routines, and cross-functional working agreements for a newly formed product team during an early Scrum transition.

Product Manager / Product Owner

Apr 2008 - Sep 2012

ACD Systems International Inc. | Victoria, BC

- Product Manager for ACDSee Pro for Mac v1; owned product definition, workflow design, prioritization, release readiness, and launch coordination for a user-facing professional desktop product.
- Used user research, market evidence, customer feedback, and technical constraints to analyze workflows and prioritize improvements across Windows and Mac releases; designed Quick Search for metadata-rich photo libraries.
- Helped lead the ACDSee Pro for Mac public beta, incorporating feedback from more than 10,000 users into product decisions, validation, issue resolution, and commercial-release readiness.
- Created interaction prototypes and successfully advocated for a workflow-based redesign of ACDSee Pro 3, translating observed user needs into a more coherent product experience that later informed ACDSee Pro for Mac v1.

User Research Analyst / Specialist

Feb 2005 - Mar 2008

Adobe Systems Inc. | San Jose, CA

- Worked on Adobe's Global Market Research team supporting Adobe Acrobat 8 / Reader 8 and early Acrobat 9 research; synthesized surveys and user studies into messaging, positioning, customer-understanding, and product recommendations.
- Supported the Adobe-Google Toolbar distribution initiative during a major commercial negotiation by rapidly building an interactive Macromedia Director prototype and conducting focused usability testing, giving partnership stakeholders evidence about how the proposed experience would feel to Adobe users.
- Worked with external research vendors, including Harris Interactive and specialized user research consultants, coordinating large-sample studies and translating findings into actionable product and messaging recommendations.

Design Researcher / Usability Engineer

Oct 2001 - Jan 2005

Microsoft Corporation | Redmond, WA

- Conducted usability research and design evaluation for Microsoft Office Visio 2003 and broader Office and enterprise experiences, including usability testing for SharePoint Portal Server Search, My Sites, and List Management.
- Translated observed user behavior into actionable product and design guidance, helping cross-functional teams identify workflow friction, understand end-user needs, and make informed product trade-offs.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATION

- Master of Library & Information Studies (MLIS), McGill University
- MA, Human Development & Applied Psychology, University of Toronto - HCI / applied cognitive science; formal experimental design and controlled interface testing
- BSc (Honours), Psychology; Minor in Mathematics, Dalhousie University
- Professional Scrum Master I (PSM I), Scrum.org, 2017

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS & MEDIA

- The Decision to Build - work in progress; a book documenting the product-development practices, architecture decisions, and human-AI collaboration behind Red5Sorcery Data Sculptor.
- Secrets & Source Code - Red5Sorcery Books & Media, 2026. Print: Blurb | Digital: Etsy
- The Product Management Diary - daily YouTube series documenting product decisions, technical trade-offs, QA, communication, and the ongoing development of Data Sculptor.
- Large, A., Beheshti, J., & Rahman, T. (2002). "Gender Differences in Collaborative Web Searching Behavior: An Elementary School Study." Information Processing & Management, 38(3), 427-443. DOI: 10.1016/S0306-4573(01)00034-6
- Large, A., Beheshti, J., & Rahman, T. (2002). "Design Criteria for Children's Web Portals: The Users Speak Out." Journal of the American Society for Information Science and Technology, 53(2), 79-94. DOI: 10.1002/asi.10012
- Rahman, T., & Muter, P. (1999). "Designing an Interface to Optimize Reading with Small Display Windows." Human Factors, 41(1), 106-117. DOI: 10.1518/001872099779577264

SELECTED TOOLS & METHODS

Product & business systems: product ownership, product strategy, roadmaps, backlog prioritization, business and workflow analysis, requirements, user stories, acceptance criteria, process improvement, interaction and workflow design, release planning, acceptance testing / validation, QA collaboration, Agile/Scrum, Jira, Confluence, SharePoint, technical documentation, stakeholder communication. Technical & AI: SQL & PostgreSQL (working proficiency), relational schema analysis, Oracle and Microsoft relational database environments, Rust, WebAssembly, Sycamore, GitHub; ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini; structured multi-model workflows for research synthesis, requirements, critique, implementation support, QA, documentation, evaluation, and verification. Research & analytics: qualitative and quantitative research, statistical reporting and publication, executive briefing, infographic/data visualization, usability testing, experimental design, analytical decision-making, data cleaning and standardization, reference-data and code mapping, data quality and validation, external data acquisition, Microsoft Excel, Tableau, Power Query/M, open-data publishing and dataset stewardship, public-information/FOIPOP data support, cross-unit data preparation.